MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CORD, DETONATING

This specification is approved for use by the Naval Air Systems Command, Department of the Navy, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 Scope. This specification establishes the requirements for manufacture and acceptance of a detonating cord, critical item, referred to herein as the cord.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS.

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-S-23586	Sealing Compound, Electrical, Silicone Rubber, Accelerator Required.
MIL-B-85251	Bomb, Binary Chemical, BLU-80/B.

Beneficial comments (recommendations additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commanding Officer, Naval Air Engineering Center, Engineering Specifications and Standards Department (ESSD) Code 93, Lakehurst, NJ 08733, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 1377

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-102	Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-109	Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-453	Radiographic Inspection.
MIL-STD-810	Environmental Test Methods.
MIL-STD-1168	Ammunition Lot Numbering.
MIL-STD-45662	Calibration System Requirements.

PUBLICATIONS

Naval Sea Systems Command
(Code Ident 10001)

WS-5003	HNS Explosive.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specified procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION

Code of Federal Regulations.

49 CFR 171-178	Transportation.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS.

3.1 Item description. The cord is an aluminum sheath containing 2.50 +0.25, -0.00 grains per foot (gr/ft) of Hexanitrostilebene (HNS), Type II, Grade A explosive recrystallized from an approved organic solvent system.

3.2 Characteristics.

3.2.1 Performance.

3.2.1.1 Detonation velocity. The cord shall have a detonation velocity of not less than 6,000 meters per second.

3.2.1.2 Low temperature. The cord shall withstand a temperature of -62 degrees Celsius (°C) for 336 hours without degradation of performance.

3.2.1.3 High temperature. The cord shall withstand a temperature of +74°C for 336 hours without degradation of performance.

3.2.1.4 Impact resistance. The cord, when mounted on a steel plate, shall not detonate, deflagrate, or burn when impacted with a 20.0 ±0.5 pound solid-steel ball dropped from a height of 30.0 +0.5, -0.0 inches.

3.2.1.5 Thermal shock. The cord shall withstand alternate sequential exposure to temperatures of -48°C for 90 minutes, +75°C for 30 minutes, and +254°C for 5 minutes without degradation of performance, and shall not constitute a safety hazard after exposure to thermal shock.

3.2.1.6 Minimum bend radius. The cord shall withstand being bent on a radius of 0.5 inch without visual signs of cracking or splitting of the metal sheath or degradation of performance.

3.2.1.7 High temperature (safety). The cord shall withstand alternate sequential exposure to temperatures of +99 ±3°C for 2 hours, +280 ±3°C for 5 minutes, and +225 ±3°C for 20 minutes without detonating or constituting a safety hazard after the thermal exposure.

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3.3 Design and construction.

3.3.1 Materials, processes, and parts. The design and construction of the cord shall be as follows.

3.3.1.1 Material. The materials used in the manufacture of the cord shall be as follows:

a. Sheath: Seamless fine aluminum of 99.9 percent minimum purity.

b. Core: HNS, Type II, Grade A, recrystallized from an approved organic solvent system and conforming to WS-5003.

3.3.1.2 Dimensions. The cord outside diameter shall be not less than 0.073 inch nor greater than 0.076 inch.

3.3.1.3 Splicing. The cord shall be a continuous length, and shall be free of splices.

3.3.1.4 Core load. The cord core load shall be 2.50 +0.25, -0.00 gr/ft.

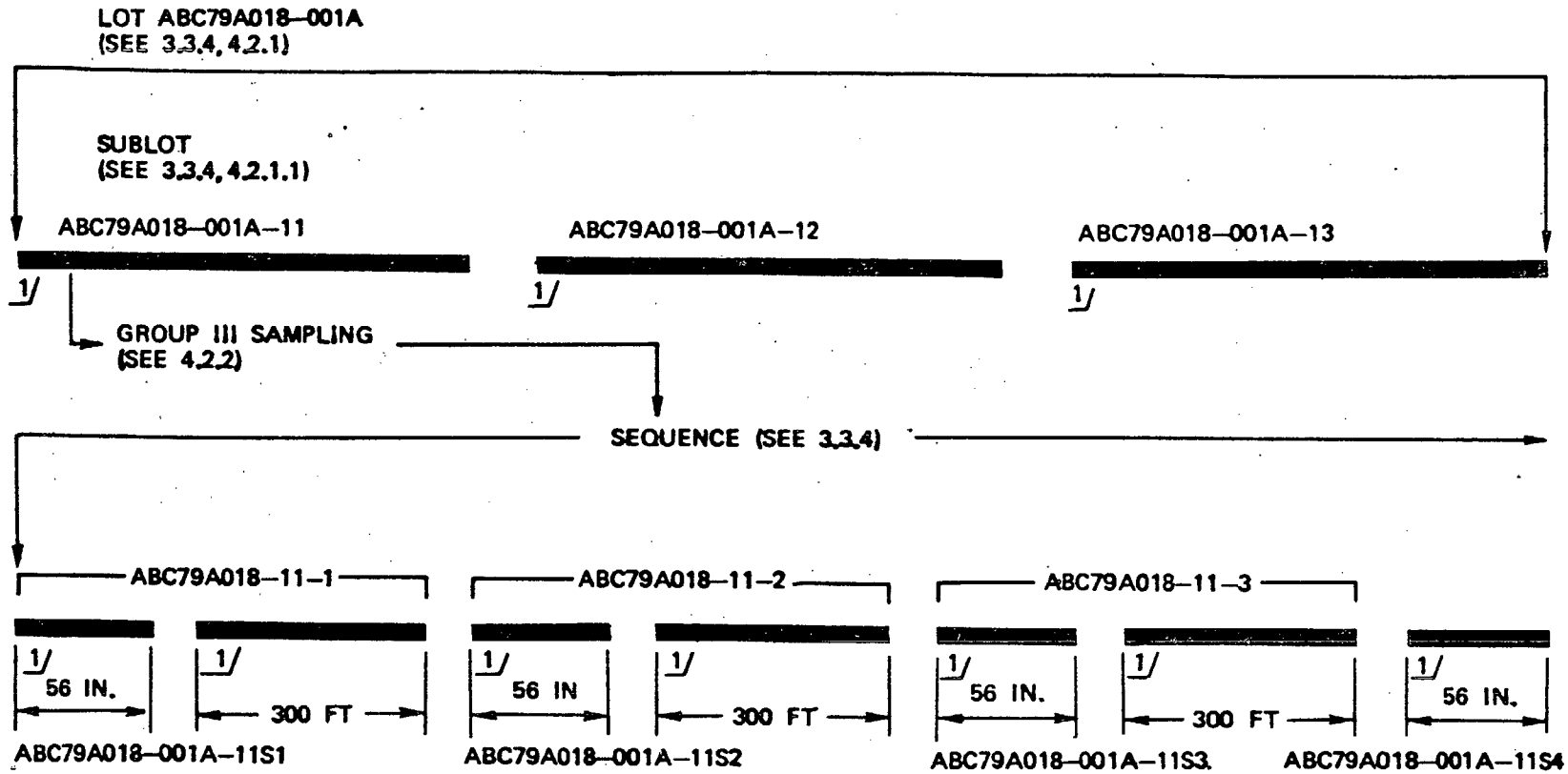
3.3.1.5 Explosive uniformity. The explosive core and metal sheath shall be continuous and shall be free from gaps, voids, inclusions, or impurities.

3.3.2 Standards of manufacture. When specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2.2), the contractor shall include written certification accompanied by objective quality evidence as defined in MIL-STD-109, that the materials, processes, and parts used in the cord meet the requirements of Section 3.

3.3.3 Identification and marking. Each piece of cord shall be legibly identified to the run from which the cord was cut. On its leading end, attach a tag or tape with the supplier's lot number, sublot number, and sequence number marked in permanent ink. Individual lengths shorter than as specified herein shall be marked by sequence number which identify the position of that sequence length within a sublot (see Figure 1). Lot numbering shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1168.

Example:	Lot	Sublot	Sequential lengths
	ABC79A018-001A	-11	-1

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NOTES:

1/ INDICATES LEADING END AND DIRECTION OF EXTRUSION.
SAMPLING LENGTHS SHOWN ARE FOR QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTIONS (SEE 4.2.2.1).
FOR PREPRODUCTION SAMPLING LENGTHS, SEE 4.1.2.2.

FIGURE 1. Detonating cord partitioning and identification.

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3.4 First article. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor shall furnish a preproduction sample consisting of one completed drawtube for first article inspection and approval (see 4.1.2.1 and 6.2.1). The preproduction sample shall be manufactured using the same methods, materials, processes, and procedures proposed for production. Any production prior to acceptance of the preproduction sample shall be totally at the risk of the contractor. Any changes in material, design, and processes, used after the manufacture of the preproduction sample, may be cause for resubmission of a preproduction sample.

3.4.1 Retest. At the discretion of the procuring activity, preproduction tests, or any portion thereof, shall be repeated under any of the following conditions:

a. When the manufacturer has modified the product (such as a change of raw materials, processes, production procedures, or methods).

b. Where there is evidence that the quality of the product has not been maintained. This evidence may be in the form of accumulated product failures, of system failures attributable to the product, or failure of the product to pass any of the tests for production lot acceptance that may be conducted by or for the procuring activity.

c. When applicable documents have been amended or revised sufficiently so that continued validity of the previous preproduction testing is questionable.

d. When the manufacturer has not produced cord to this specification for a period of 12 months or longer.

e. When manufacturer changes location at which the cord is produced.

3.5 Documentation. When specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2.2), inspection reports shall be prepared as specified in 4.1.2.5 and 4.2.4.

3.6 Workmanship. The device shall be fabricated in a manner that will ensure compliance with all requirements of this specification and the assembly drawing. The cord shall be free from cracks, scratches, gouges, dents, laps, seams, bends, kinks, or evidence of corrosion.

3.6.1 Special working environments. Special working environments for the manufacture of the cord shall be as specified in MIL-B-85251.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein (see 6.2.1). Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Classification of inspections. The examinations and tests specified herein shall be classified as follows:

a. Preproduction inspections (see 4.1.2.1).

b. Quality conformance inspections (see 4.2).

4.1.2 Special tests and examinations.

4.1.2.1 Preproduction inspections. The preproduction sample of one completed drawtube shall be subjected to the examinations and tests of Table I in the sequence shown.

4.1.2.2 Preproduction sample preparation. The preproduction sample of 3.4 shall undergo Group I examinations. Subsamples, 160 ±1 inches in length, shall then be taken from the original leading and terminal ends and from each 100 ±5 feet of the preproduction sample, however, no fewer than 10 subsamples are required. Each subsample shall be assigned a unique number for identification and tagged in the same manner as a sublot. Each subsample shall be sectioned for testing as follows:

a. Cut off 2.0° ±0.1 inches from each end and discard.

b. Cut off the succeeding 6.0 ±0.1 inches and reserve for core load tests (see 4.3.3).

c. Cut off the succeeding 24.0 ±0.1 inches and reserve for detonation velocity tests (see 4.3.4).

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d. Cut off the succeeding 24.0 ±0.1 inches and reserve for the low-temperature test (see 4.3.5).

e. Cut off the succeeding 24.0 ±0.1 inches and reserve for high-temperature tests (see 4.3.6).

f. Cut off the succeeding 24.0 ±0.1 inches and reserve for the thermal-shock test (see 4.3.8).

g. Cut off the succeeding 24.0 ±0.1 inches and reserve for the minimum bend-radius tests (see 4.3.9).

h. Cut off the succeeding 6.0 ±0.1 inches and reserve for the impact-resistance test (see 4.3.7).

i. Reserve the remaining for high-temperature (safety) test (see 4.3.11).

TABLE I. Preproduction inspections.

Examination or test	Requirement paragraph	Method paragraph
Group I		
Visual and mechanical	3.3.1.1, 3.3.1.2, 3.3.1.3, 3.3.2, 3.3.3, 3.6	4.3.2
Radiographic inspection	3.3.1.5	4.3.10
Group II		
Core load	3.3.1.4, 3.3.1.5	4.3.3
Detonation velocity	3.2.1.1	4.3.4
Minimum bend radius	3.2.1.6	4.3.9
Impact resistance	3.2.1.4	4.3.7
Group III		
High temperature	3.2.1.3	4.3.6
Low temperature	3.2.1.2	4.3.5
Thermal shock	3.2.1.5	4.3.8
High temperature (safety)	3.2.1.7	4.3.11

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4.1.2.3 Acceptance criteria. Failure of one or more cords in the preproduction sample to pass any of the preproduction tests shall cause rejection of the preproduction sample.

4.1.2.4 Disposition of preproduction sample. If results of the preproduction sample tests of Table I are acceptable, unused portions of the preproduction sample cord may be marked for use in hardware applications upon receipt of written approval from the procuring activity (see 6.2.1).

4.1.2.5 Preproduction inspection report. When specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2.2), results of the preproduction inspections shall be prepared for the procuring activity. The report shall contain the following information, including a certification which attests that the information provided is correct and applicable to the product being submitted:

a. A statement that the preproduction sample complies with all quality assurance provisions of this specification for the cord specified in the contract or purchase order.

b. Number of units of product inspected.

c. Results obtained for all inspections performed, including copies of raw data for core load and detonation velocity measurements.

d. Contract or purchase order number and date, together with an identification and date of changes.

e. Certificates of compliance of all material procured directly by the contractor.

f. Date submitted.

The certification shall be signed by a responsible agent of the certifying organization. The initial certification shall be substantiated by evidence of the agent's authority to bind his principal. Substantiation of the agent's authority will not be required with subsequent certifications unless, during the course of the contract, this authority is vested in another agent of the certifying organization.

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4.2 Quality conformance inspections. Each inspection lot of cord submitted for acceptance shall be subjected to the examinations and tests specified in Table II, in the sequence shown.

TABLE II. Quality conformance inspections.

Examination or test	Requirement paragraph	Method paragraph
Group I		
Certification	3.3.2	4.2.4
Group II (100%)		
Visual examination	3.3.1.1, 3.3.1.2 3.3.1.3, 3.3.2 3.3.2, 3.3.3, 3.6	4.3.2
Radiographic inspection	3.3.1.5	4.3.10
Group III (sample)		
Core load	3.3.1.4, 3.3.1.5	4.3.3
Detonation velocity	3.2.1.1	4.3.4
Minimum bend radius	3.2.1.6	4.3.9

4.2.1 Lot. A lot shall not exceed that quantity of cord produced in one continuous process using a single lot of HNS, Type II, Grade A explosive recrystallized from an approved organic solvent system, and a single lot of sheathing material. Homogeneity shall be considered to exist provided the lot has been produced by one manufacturer, in one unchanged process, in accordance with this specification.

4.2.1.1 Sublot. A sublot shall consist of one length of draw tube of sheath material fabricated into a single extrusion. Each sublot shall constitute an inspection lot. Quality conformance inspections shall be performed on each inspection lot for acceptance or rejection of the lot represented.

4.2.2 Sampling. Sampling for quality conformance inspections shall be as follows:

a. Group I: No sample; certification required for each inspection lot.

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b. Group II: No sample; 100 percent of each inspection lot shall be subjected to Group II inspections.

c. Group III: Each inspection lot shall be sampled for Group III tests by taking one 56 ±1 inch sample length from the original leading and terminal ends, and one 56 ±1 inch sample length from each 300 ±10 feet of cord in the inspection lot (see Figure 1). Each sample shall be uniquely identified as to the sample's origin in an inspection lot.

4.2.2.1 Sample sectioning. Each of the Group III samples shall be sectioned for testing as follows:

a. Cut off 1.0 ±0.1 inches of the original leading and terminal end and discard.

b. Cut off the succeeding 6.0 ±0.1 inches and reserve for the core load test (see 4.3.3).

c. Cut off the succeeding 24.0 ±0.1 inches and reserve for detonation velocity test (see 4.3.4).

d. Reserve the remaining for the minimum bend radius test (see 4.3.9).

4.2.3 Acceptance criteria. Failure of any sample to pass any of the Group II or Group III tests shall reject the inspection lot represented.

4.2.4 Quality conformance inspection report. When specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2.2), results of the quality conformance inspection shall be included with each lot. Reports shall contain the following information, accompanied by a certification which attests that the information provided is correct and applicable to the product being submitted:

a. A statement that the lot complies with all quality assurance provisions of this specification for the cord specified in the contract or purchase order.

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b. Number of units of product inspected.

c. Results obtained for all inspections performed, including copies of raw data for core load and all detonation velocity measurements.

d. Contract or purchase order number and date, together with an identification and date of changes.

e. Certificates of compliance of all material procured directly by the contractor.

f. Number of items in the lot.

g. Date submitted.

The certification shall be signed by a responsible agent of the certifying organization. The initial certification shall be substantiated by evidence of the agent's authority to bind his principal. Substantiation of the agent's authority will not be required with subsequent certifications unless, during the course of the contract, this authority is vested in another agent of the certifying organization.

4.3 Inspection methods.

4.3.1 Test equipment and conditions.

4.3.1.1 Standard test equipment. The contractor shall provide and maintain an adequate system of test equipment necessary to ensure that parts and products will meet the specification requirements at the rate of delivery specified in the contract or purchase order. The calibration of measuring and test equipment shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-45662. Test equipment, including associated calibration programs and operation and maintenance procedures, are subjected to disapproval by the procuring activity. When special test equipment and circuits are devised or commercially available equipment is employed, such equipment circuits and methods are subject to disapproval by the procuring activity. Unless otherwise specified herein, the magnitude of any error introduced by test equipment shall not exceed 10 percent of the tolerance of the requirement being measured.

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4.3.1.2 Test conditions. Unless otherwise specified herein, all tests shall be conducted at the test area ambient temperature and relative humidity. Where special conditions of tests are specified, equipment employed shall adequately provide specified conditions, and all monitoring and measurement devices shall conform to the requirements of 4.3.1.1. When special conditions of tests are not imposed, commercially available direct-measurement equipment may be employed provided they conform to the requirements of 4.3.1.1.

4.3.2 Visual and mechanical examination. The cord shall be examined to determine compliance with dimensions, identification, and workmanship (see 3.3.1.1, 3.3.1.2, 3.3.1.3, 3.3.2, 3.3.3, and 3.6).

4.3.3 Core load. The cord test samples shall be weighed before and after dissolving out the explosive core. To be acceptable, the core load shall be as specified in 3.3.1.4.

4.3.4 Detonation velocity. The detonation velocity measurement shall be made with an electric time intervalometer, an oscilloscope, or similar method capable of an accuracy of ±0.5 percent. The measurement shall be made over a 15.0 ±0.1 inch section of the nominal 24-inch test sample and located 1.0 ±0.1 inches from the end of the cord opposite the detonator (see Figure 2). The detonation velocity and cord temperature immediately prior to firing shall be recorded. To be acceptable, the detonation velocity shall be as specified in 3.2.1.1.

4.3.5 Low-temperature test. The cord samples shall be subjected to the low temperature test of MIL-STD-810, Method 502.1, except that the temperature shall be -62 ±3°C and the test time shall be no less than 336 hours. The cord samples shall then be fired at ambient temperature and detonation velocity measured as specified in 4.3.4. To be acceptable, the detonating velocity shall be not less than that specified in 3.2.1.1.

4.3.6 High-temperature test. Testing shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-810. The cord samples shall be placed in a temperature conditioned chamber maintained at an internal temperature of 74 ±3°C for no less than 336 hours. The cord samples shall then be fired at ambient temperature and detonation velocity measured in accordance with 4.3.4. To be acceptable, the detonation velocity shall be not less than that specified in 3.2.1.1.

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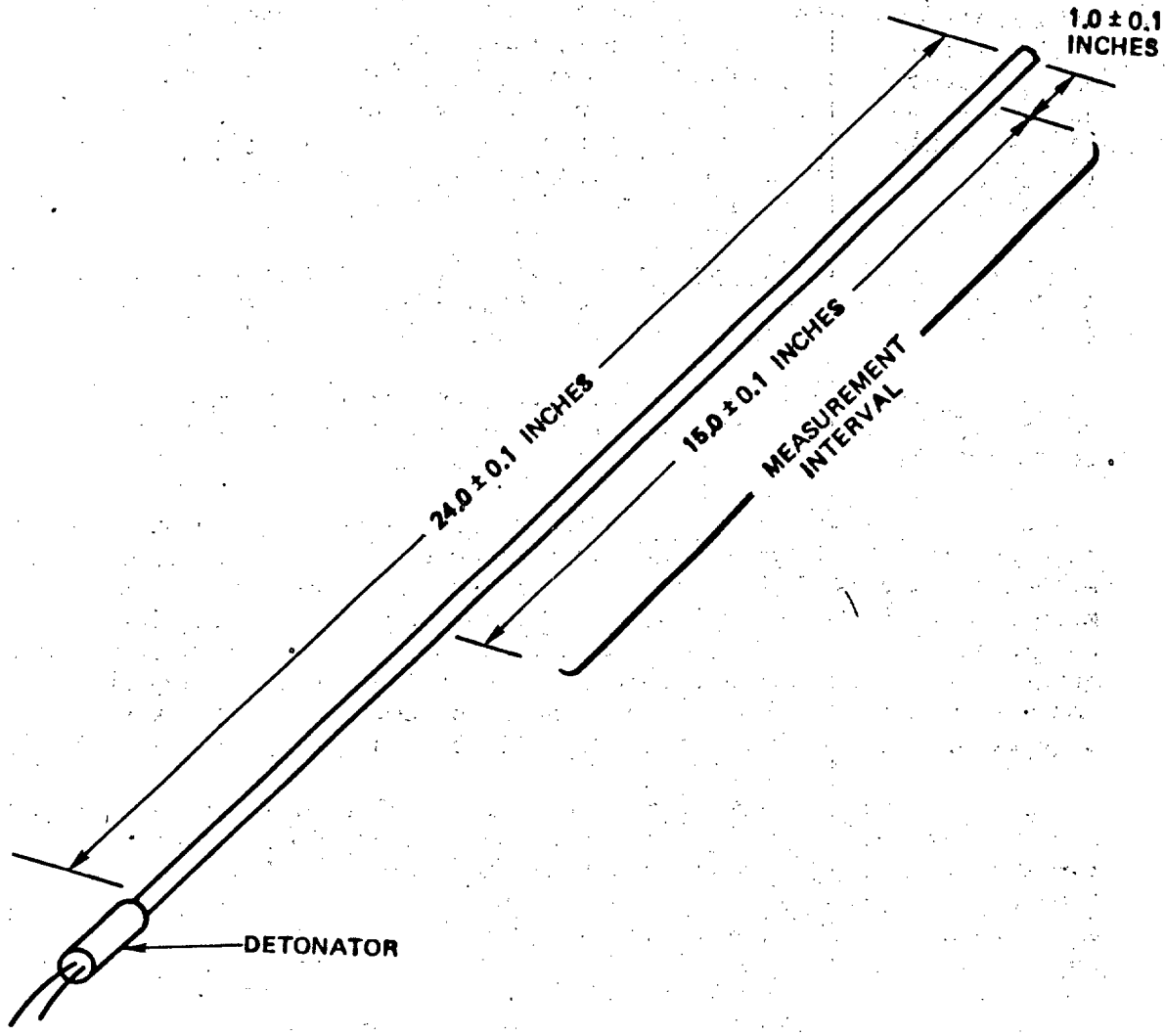


FIGURE 2. Detonation velocity test arrangement.

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4.3.7 Impact-resistance test. The cord sample shall be placed between two steel plates (2 x 2 x 0.25 inches) supported by a solid base (see Figure 3). The upper plate shall be impacted by a solid steel ball weighing 20.0 ±0.5 pounds dropped from a height of 30.0 +0.5, -0.0 inches. The cord shall meet the requirements of 3.2.1.4 and shall not detonate, deflagrate, or burn as a result of impact, and shall be safe to handle and dispose of.

4.3.8 Thermal shock. Testing shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-810. Place cord samples in a temperature-conditioned chamber maintained at an internal temperature of -48 ±3°C for no less than 90 minutes. At the end of the 90-minute period, transfer the samples to a chamber temperature conditioned to +75 ±3°C. Complete the transfer between the two chambers within 1 minute. The samples shall remain in the chamber for no less than 30 minutes. At the end of the 30-minute period, transfer the samples to a chamber temperature conditoned to +254 ±3°C. Complete the transfer between chambers within 1 minute. The samples shall remain in the chamber for no less than 5 minutes. Then the cord samples shall be fired and detonation velocity measurement made in accordance with 4.3.4 at a temperature of +254 ±3°C. To be acceptable, the detonating velocity shall be not less than that specified in 3.2.1.1.

4.3.9 Minimum bend radius. The minimum bend radius capability shall be determined by spirally wrapping five complete 360-degree turns around a 1-inch diameter rod starting at one end of the sample then unwinding the sample until straightened (see Figure 4). This end of the sample shall be identified for later use in conducting the detonation velocity test. This procedure shall be repeated for a total of three times, using the same segment of the sample each time. Any evidence of cracking, splitting, or breaking of the metal sheath shall reject the inspection lot represented. The detonation-velocity test of 4.3.4 shall be conducted on the sample at ambient temperature. The detonation velocity shall be measured over a 15-inch segment, starting 1-inch from the sample end identified above. To be acceptable, the detonation velocity shall be as specified in 3.2.1.1, and shall vary by not more than 5 percent from the detonation velocity determined from the sample of 4.1.2.2c or 4.2.2.1c, as applicable.

4.3.10 Radiographic inspection. Radiographic inspection of the cord shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-453. To be acceptable, the cord shall meet the requirements of 3.3.1.5.

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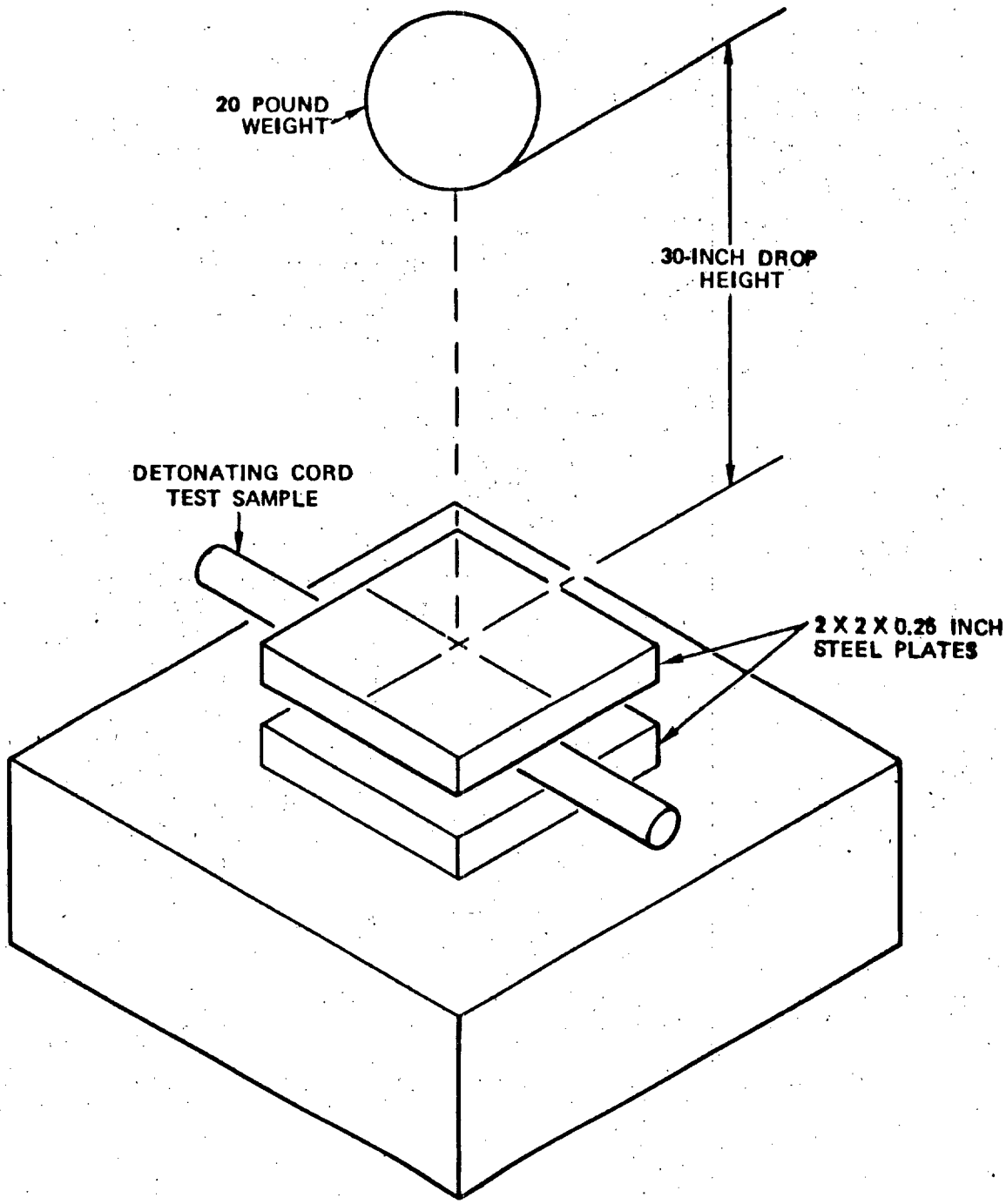


FIGURE 3. Impact resistance test arrangement.

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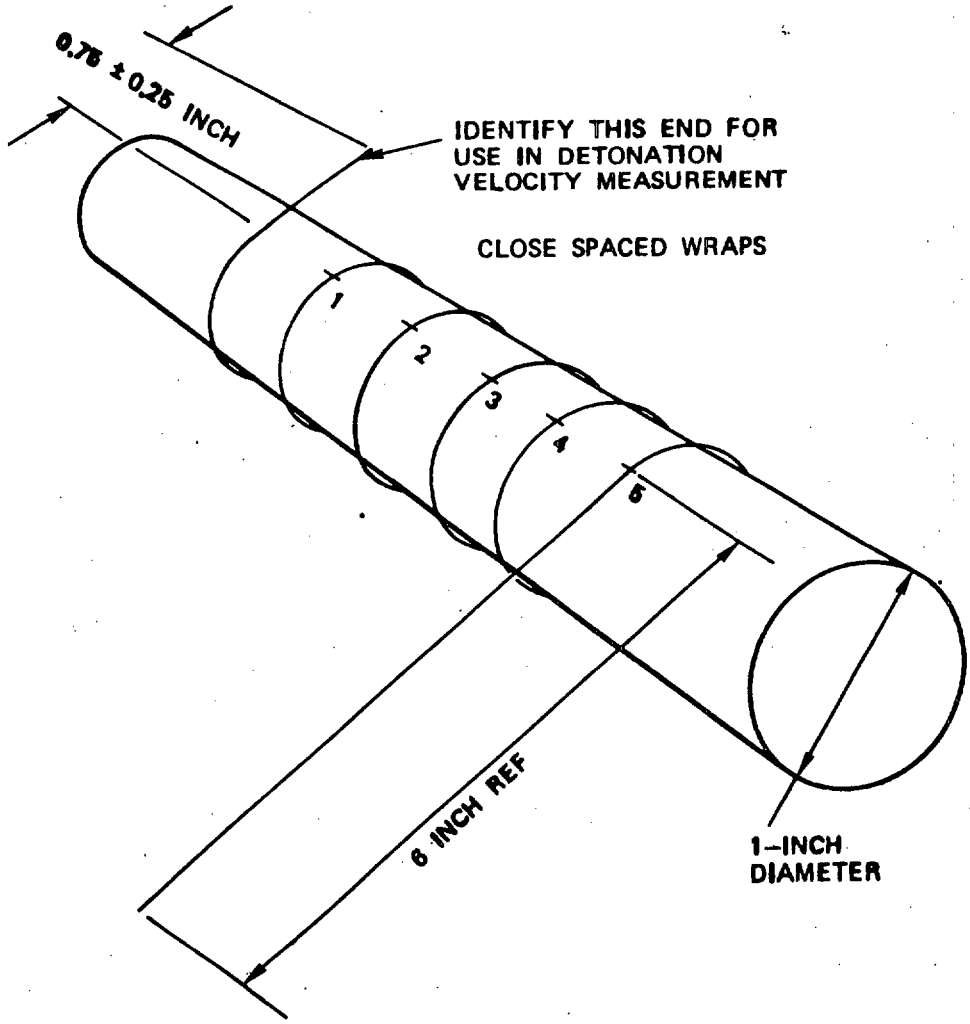


FIGURE 4. Minimum bending radius test arrangment.

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4.3.11 High temperature (safety) test. Testing shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-810. The cord samples shall be placed in a temperature-conditioned chamber maintained at an internal temperature of 99 ±3°C for 120 minutes. At the end of the 120-minute period, transfer the cord samples to a chamber which is temperature conditioned to +280 ±3°C. Complete the transfer between the two chambers within 1 minute. The cord samples shall remain in the 280°C chamber for 5 minutes. At the end of the 5-minute period, transfer the cord samples to a chamber maintained at an internal temperature of +225 ±3°C for 20 minutes. Complete the transfer between the two chambers within 1 minute. To be acceptable, the cord shall meet the requirements of 3.2.1.7 and shall not detonate, deflagrate, or burn as a result of the high temperature (safety) test, and shall be safe to handle and dispose of.

4.4 Packaging, packing, and marking. Prior to shipment, examination shall be made to ensure that packaging, packing, and marking are in accordance with the requirements of Section 5.

5. PACKAGING.

5.1 Preservation-packaging. Preservation and packaging shall be Level C in accordance with FED-STD-102.

5.1.1 Preservation. Preservatives shall not be used. The free ends of each length of cord shall be sealed using rubber compound, MIL-S-23586, Type III, Class 2, Grade A, with primer recommended by the manufacturer of the rubber compound. Length of the seal coating shall be not greater than 0.50 inch.

5.1.2 Packaging. Lengths of cord shall be packaged in a manner to assure delivery to the first destination without corrosion, deterioration, or damage to the cord. Packaging shall conform to the Code of Federal Regulations, 49 CFR 171-178, for shipment of Class A explosives.

5.2. Packing. Packing shall be Level C in accordance with FED-STD-102. The assemblies shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the applicable carrier rules and regulations for Level C. Packing shall conform

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to the Code of Federal Regulations, 49 CFR 171-178, for shipment of Class A explosives.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or purchase order (see 6.2.1), each package and shipping container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES AND CONCLUDING MATERIAL.

6.1 Intended use. The cord is intended to transmit the explosive energy, in a detonation energy transfer system.

6.2 Ordering data.

6.2.1 Procurement requirements. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. When a first article is required, it should be tested and approved under the appropriate provisions of 7-104.55 of the Defense Acquisition Regulations (DAR). The first article should be a preproduction sample consisting of one completed drawtube as specified in 3.4. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments, regarding arrangements for examinations, test and approval of the first article.

c. Responsibility for inspection and test facilities if different from 4.1.

d. Disposition of preproduction sample (see 4.1.2.4).

e. Special marking (see 5.3).

6.2.2 Data requirements. When this specification is used in a procurement which incorporates a Contract Data Requirements List (DD Form 1423) and invokes the provisions of 7-104.9(n) of the DAR, the data requirements identified below will be developed as specified by an approved Data Item Description (DID) (DD Form 1664) and delivered in accordance with the approved DD Form 1423

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incorporated in the contract. When the provisions of DAR 7-104.9(n) are not invoked, the data specified below will be delivered by the contractor in accordance with the contract requirements. Deliverable data required by this specification are cited as follows:

Paragraph	Data Requirement	Applicable DID
3.3.2, 4.1.2.5, 4.2.4	Certification of compliance	DI-E-2121
3.5, 4.1.2.5, 4.2.4	Inspection report	DI-T-2072

(Copies of DIDs required by the contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

6.3 Safety precautions. The loading, assembly, and handling of the explosives, subassemblies, and finished items covered by this specification involve hazardous operations and require explosive safety precautions as stated in DoD 4145.26M.

Preparing activity:
Navy - AS

(Project 1377-N674)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

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